Minister Yogi Adityanath's council of ministers and 35.6 per cent of the BJP's district-level presidents (see Figure 3.1). These findings show that the Ashoka University database, which is the basis of most academic and journalistic writings on the caste of Hindi heartland politicians, got its facts wrong on this score. Ashoka's researchers missed the enormity of the larger process of incorporation of key groups such as OBCs and SCs into the BJP's fold. Put simply, they read the caste-names wrong. At best, this was shoddy research caused by a lack of understanding of ground realities. The basic factual mistakes in the core database unfortunately led scholars and observers who use it to come up with an incorrect or incomplete assessment of the evidence and a skewed understanding of the BJP's growth. This led to as seasoned and fine a scholar as Jaffrelot to mistakenly infer continued dominance of upper castes in the BJP.

Figure 3.1: BJP OBC and SC Representation in BJP Leadership in UP: Topline View